

Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

SATURDAY, DECEMBER 6, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Waymo has eyes on state

But self-driving taxis face hurdles in Land of Lincoln

By Talia Soglin and Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

Waymo wants Illinoisans to hail driverless cabs. But the company will need to overcome legal hurdles — and concerns about its vehicles' safety — before it can

bring self-driving taxis to the Land of Lincoln.

The company has been advertising in Illinois for some time, urging residents to contact their legislators to encourage them to bring Waymo here. In an email to the Tribune, Waymo spokesperson Ethan Teicher confirmed the company was “currently working with the legislature to determine what the best path forward is for enabling Illinois residents to access our

safe, transformative, technology.”

Republican state Rep. Brad Stephens of Rosemont is among several lawmakers this year who've introduced legislation that could bring those vehicles to Illinois, though none of the bills have advanced through the legislature. Legislation is likely needed to authorize Waymo to operate its vehicles in Illinois, according to state officials.

Turn to Waymo, Page 2

Panel shuns babies' vaccine

Federal committee votes to end recommendation for hepatitis B shot at birth

By Mike Stobbe
Associated Press

NEW YORK — A federal vaccine advisory committee voted Friday to end the long-standing recommendation that all U.S. babies get the hepatitis B vaccine on the day they're born.

A loud chorus of medical and public health leaders decried the actions of the panel, whose current members were all appointed by Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. — a leading anti-vaccine activist before this year becoming the nation's top health official.

“This is the group that can't shoot straight,” said Dr. William Schaffner, a Vanderbilt University vaccine expert who for decades has been involved with ACIP and its workgroups.

Several medical societies and state health departments said they would continue to recommend them. While people may have to check their policies, the trade group AHIP, formerly known as America's Health Insurance Plans, said its members still will cover the birth dose of the hepatitis B vaccine.

For decades, the government has advised that all babies be vaccinated against the liver infection right after birth. The shots are widely considered to be a public health success for preventing thousands of illnesses.

But Kennedy's Advisory Committee on Immunization Practices decided to recommend the birth dose only for babies whose mothers test positive, and in cases where the mom wasn't tested.

For other babies, it will be up to parents and their doctors to decide if a birth dose is appropriate. The committee voted 8-3 to suggest that if a family elects to wait, then the vaccination series should begin when the child is 2 months old.

The acting director of the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, Jim O'Neill, is expected to decide later whether to accept the committee's recommendation.

The decision marks a return to a health strategy abandoned more than three decades ago.

Asked why the newly-appointed committee moved quickly to reexamine the recommendation, committee

Turn to Vaccine, Page 4

■ Illinois will conduct its own review of a federal committee's decision to no longer recommend that all babies get the hepatitis B vaccine. **Business**



JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

All aboard the C-T-Sleigh

Santa, lower left, waves aboard an open-air car on the CTA Holiday Train traveling south toward the Merchandise Mart on Wednesday. The decked-out train, a CTA tradition for more than three decades, is scheduled to travel on all eight lines, wrapping up Dec. 22 on the Yellow Line. The CTA's Holiday Bus is scheduled to hit 19 of the city's bus routes through Dec. 20.

Give this guy a break

Every point the Bears lose by this year, he runs a mile. Sunday's stakes are higher: His fiancée is a Packers fan

By Cam'ron Hardy | Chicago Tribune

Chase Bandolik caught everyone's attention when he ran 31 miles, in a row, for every point lost by the Chicago Bears against the Detroit Lions in early September — including the Bears.

Star quarterback Caleb Williams and wide receiver DJ Moore — who this week was named the Bears winner of the Walter Payton Man of the Year Award — have interacted with his social media accounts. Last month, the Bears sent Bandolik a gift

package filled with Bears socks, pajamas, blankets and other gear.

Now, the Bears are 9-3. On Sunday, they're set to face the Green Bay Packers, 8-3-1, at Lambeau Field. The winner of the matchup will take the lead in the NFC North and possibly maintain the top seed in the conference.

For Bandolik, who has been running

Turn to Bears, Page 4



Packers fan Rylee Jade Ollearis, left, and fiancée Chase Bandolik, a Bears fan, in suburban Northbrook on Thursday.

CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Pair of crashes reveal dangers of impaired, distracted driving

By Robert McCoppin
Chicago Tribune

A fatal crash that may have occurred while the driver was livestreaming on TikTok, and a severe sentence in a fatal drunken driving crash, highlight continued dangers from impaired and distracted driving as the holidays approach.

In the TikTok case, police are investigating whether a woman was taking video of herself on the app while driving and striking a man in Zion.

Darren Lucas, 59, who worked at Torres Fresh Market, was crossing Sheridan Road after work to catch a bus home Nov. 3 when he was struck and killed, police said. The driver, a 43-year-old woman, stopped and called 911.

A woman under the pseudonym tea_tyme_3 streaming herself live on TikTok the same day suddenly screamed and swore, and said she had hit someone. Police were investigating, and have obtained search warrants to seize the driver's phone and social media accounts, Lt. Paul Kehrli said.

In an unrelated case, a DuPage County judge sentenced a woman to 21 years in prison for striking and killing a brother and sister in a drunken driving crash near Winfield in June 2023.

Prosecutors said Christine Brocious, 39, of Chicago Ridge, maneuvered her car between two other vehicles stopped at a red light, ran the red light, and T-boned

Turn to Crashes, Page 4

“Why didn't she call Uber or her family? She killed my two lovely children, and she enjoyed the next day of her life. She can never bring back my kids.”

— Glentina Cukali, mother of two people killed in a 2023 crash near Winfield

FRANK GEHRY 1929-2025



TERRY HARRIS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A giant of Chicago's lakefront and beyond

Architect Frank Gehry, above, unveils his design for a Millennium Park band shell and seating area on Nov. 3, 1999, in Chicago. Gehry, who built some of the world's most striking buildings and who achieved a level of worldwide acclaim seldom afforded any architect, died at his home Friday after a brief respiratory illness. He was 96. **Chicagoland, Page 6**

